Calvin University 1876



COMPUTER SCIENCE









DEPARTMENT DISTINCTIVES

At the Computer Science Department you can major in three ways: the Bachelor of Computer Science (BCS), Computer Science Plus (BS in CS), or Data Science (BS in DS). There are also minors in computer science, data science and data analytics, and a new certificate in cybersecurity. Students work beside professors who research artificial intelligence and publish on how computing is taught. A liberal arts core means you graduate able to write and communicate in addition to coding, and every professor is a committed Christian who brings their faith to bear on teaching and research.

BACHELOR OF COMPUTER SCIENCE (BCS)

The BCS is ABET-accredited, meeting the same standards as programs at major research universities. Coursework spans algorithms, artificial intelligence, security, databases, networks, and software engineering. Graduates move into software development, networking, and systems work, or on to graduate study at places like Johns Hopkins, MSU, Michigan Tech, Purdue and the University of Sydney.

COMPUTER SCIENCE PLUS (BS IN CS)

A full computer science degree paired with a second field, for students who want to bring computing to the subject they care about: business, psychology, languages, or another field entirely. Our Strategic Partners Council regularly reviews the curriculum so it tracks the technologies employers actually use, and students may take paid internships and do research with faculty.

DATA SCIENCE (BS IN DS)

Calvin was among the first Christian institutions to offer data science. Students combine computer science, statistics, and mathematics with four to five courses in a second discipline such as biology, geography, business, economics, or political science, then finish with a capstone project on real data.

CYBERSECURITY CERTIFICATE NEW FOR FALL 2026

Eighteen credit hours in cryptography, network defense, and system administration, designed around the NSA's Cyber Defense knowledge units and taught by a professor with three decades in network security. BCS students earn the certificate inside their existing major with no added credit hours. The Bureau of Labor Statistics projects this field will grow 21 percent between 2025 and 2035.